

Chapter 160-5

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The day after Liang Shi finished recording the show, she received a call from Gu Xingyue. She said she wanted to meet Feng Xian, but instructed Liang Shi not to tell Feng Xian beforehand.

After getting Zhao Xuning's consent, Liang Shi arranged a gathering and invited Feng Xian out under the pretense of wanting to consult about a script.

The meeting place was at a teahouse. Zhao Xuning, who wasn't on duty, came along as well.

Feng Xian was slender, with an elegant and refined air about her. She wasn't wearing glasses. Upon seeing Liang Shi, she gave a slight nod. "Hello."

Liang Shi greeted her: "Hello, Teacher."

Gu Xingyue arrived late. By the time she came, everyone had already been sitting there chatting for a while. When Liang Shi chatted with Feng Xian, she could tell this was someone with deep literary accomplishment.

Moreover, she wasn't condescending at all. She didn't look down on Liang Shi for being a graduate of a third-rate university just because she herself was a literature professor. Instead, she explained things very gently, even breaking them down into simple pieces for her to understand.

Liang Shi listened comfortably and attentively.

When Gu Xingyue came in, she first made eye contact with Feng Xian, and then both of them paused. After a long moment of looking at each other, they both smiled and said in unison: "So it's you."

They had met before at the hospital, though they had only exchanged one sentence.

It could also be considered a brief encounter.

Gu Xingyue sat across from her, quiet and well-behaved, not saying anything, just listening in silence.

When Feng Xian finished speaking, Gu Xingyue silently poured her another cup of tea.

Everyone had some pastries, then headed to a restaurant for a proper meal.

Zhao Xuning followed behind Feng Xian the whole way, very considerate.

During the meal, Gu Xingyue suddenly asked: "I heard you lost a daughter?"

Feng Xian was picking up food with her chopsticks when her hand trembled, and the food fell onto the table.

Feng Xian's lips quivered. It was clear that mentioning this was somewhat difficult for her to accept, but she still said: "Yes."

Just bringing it up made her voice choke.

Gu Xingyue placed some food into her bowl with her chopsticks. "Please don't get too emotional."

"I'm not." Feng Xian smiled faintly. "It's been a long time since anyone brought up this topic with me."

That was why she had gotten emotional when she first heard it.

But after the emotion came an overwhelming sense of loss.

After so many years of searching, she had already given up.

Only a tiny sliver of hope remained in her heart to sustain her.

Gu Xingyue asked: "Then how did you lose your daughter?"

Feng Xian lowered her eyes, and a tear fell into her bowl. Her shoulders trembled slightly, but she still maintained her composure. "Her father had met some business friends back then and wanted to take her out to play. He said the other party also had a child. When they took them out, both children were stolen together."

As Feng Xian spoke, her hands clenched so hard that the veins on the back of her hands bulged.

"He just wanted to curry favor with those people." Feng Xian said, "If he hadn't taken our daughter out back then, my daughter wouldn't have been lost."

"Then..." Gu Xingyue paused briefly. "What about your husband?"

Feng Xian was stunned. After a long while, she sighed and said: "Dead. I divorced him because of what happened to our daughter. Not long after, his company went bankrupt and he jumped off a building."

"Have you been alone all these years?" Gu Xingyue asked.

Feng Xian nodded: "I've always wanted to find my daughter. I haven't had the heart to find another partner."

Gu Xingyue pressed her lips together and placed another serving of food into Feng Xian's bowl.

Feng Xian smiled faintly: "You don't need to pity me. All these years I've..."

Before she could finish, Gu Xingyue spoke up: "Then would you mind having another daughter?"

Feng Xian froze: "Huh?"

"I should be the daughter you lost many years ago." Gu Xingyue said as calmly as she could. "Our blood types are the same, and we produce rejection reactions¹. Dr. Zhao helped us do a DNA test, so... I am your daughter."

Feng Xian looked at Zhao Xuning in confusion.

The sudden news hit her, and she was still somewhat at a loss.

It seemed like a very long time passed before Feng Xian slowly digested the news. Tears blurred her vision, and through the watery haze she looked at Gu Xingyue, raising her hand to touch Gu Xingyue's face. "So you really are my daughter?"

"Qianqian." Feng Xian called her childhood nickname. "Qianqian."

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Even Zhao Xuning, that cold and aloof person, got teary-eyed along with them.

It took a long time for the private room to calm down. Feng Xian kept holding Gu Xingyue's hand, looking at her with full maternal love.

Before long, Feng Xian began to tell the story of those past events.

Her ex-husband's surname was Gao. After his successful startup, he had always wanted to climb higher, saying he wanted to give her and their daughter a comfortable life.

But unexpectedly, their daughter was lost, his wife left, and his family fell apart.

The other child who was stolen at the same time was the daughter of another CEO they had gone out with, surnamed Liang.

As soon as Liang was mentioned, Zhao Xuning couldn't help but look at Liang Shi.

Feng Xian also noticed this. She looked at Liang Shi: "It shouldn't be your Liang, right? That person was called Liang Zu. His wife was much calmer than me. I even hit my husband at the time."

Liang Zu...

Liang Shi gave a light cough: "It's not me, but it is that Liang."

Feng Xian was surprised: "Huh?"

Liang Shi said: "I'm not the daughter who was lost. I was picked up by Liang Zu later."

"That little girl." Feng Xian suddenly said, then paused for a moment. "It wasn't Liang Zu who picked you up, was it? It was his wife. Back then, outside Shi'an Hospital, I saw someone throw you on the ground. A little while later, his wife went over and picked you up. At the time, you were already on the verge of death... your whole face was purple."

Liang Shi was stunned. She hadn't expected that some of what Qiu Zimin said was actually true.

"How... do you know?" Liang Shi asked.

Feng Xian smiled bitterly: "To be honest with you, I suspected Liang Zu had done something back then, so I followed his wife for a while. I only gave up after confirming that their child really was lost. That's when I happened to see her pick up a child. Later I heard she treated that child very well."

Liang Shi: "....."

Sure enough, Qiu Zimin had deceived so many people.

However...

Liang Shi asked: "Did you see who abandoned me?"

"No." Feng Xian said, "That person was wearing a white headscarf, sunglasses, and a mask. They looked very suspicious, so I suspected you were an abandoned baby."

Liang Shi: "....."

Zhao Xuning, who had been listening the whole time, suddenly spoke up. "The probability of an abandoned baby appearing at Shi'an Hospital... is very small."

Liang Shi: "?"

Zhao Xuning slowly continued: "Shi'an Hospital is a high-end private hospital. The mothers who give birth there are either rich or noble... So there's an eighty percent chance there wouldn't be an abandoned baby. It's very possible that at that time, you were a... stillborn?"

Liang Shi: "?"

"There's also the possibility that you were a stolen stillborn." Zhao Xuning suddenly stared directly into Liang Shi's eyes.

Footnotes:

¹ **Rejection reactions (排異反應):** In the context of this story, this refers to a medical phenomenon where blood or tissue from closely related individuals (such as parent and child) can produce specific immune reactions. This can be used as preliminary evidence of biological relationship before DNA testing confirms it.